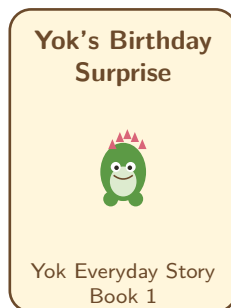


Yok's Birthday Surprise

Yok Everyday Storytime Kit

1 of 6



Inside this kit:

- Read-aloud guide
- Parent conversation card
- Practice cards
- Printable certificate
- Coloring page
- Four bookmarks
- Yok's Little Try



Themes: birthday expectations, disappointment, flexible thinking, friendship, and finding meaning when plans change.

Author: LéoN NoèL **Age:** Ages 3–6 **ISBN:** 979-8-1733-1770-4

Website: <https://leonnoelauthor.github.io/yokstories-site/>

Free for home, classroom, and library use. Not for resale.

Read-Aloud Guide



Best for: Ages 3–6

Read-aloud: 5–8 min.

Theme: birthday expectations, disappointment, flexible thinking, friendship, and finding meaning when plans change.

Approach: Let the story lead. Pause for body clues, choices, and small moments of agency rather than turning the reading into a lesson.

Before reading

- What do you hope will happen on your birthday?
- How can it feel when a special day does not go the way you imagined?
- Can a surprise be important even if it is small?

During reading

- **When Yok keeps looking for the enormous surprise:** What is she expecting, and how is that expectation affecting her day?
- **When the rain ruins the outdoor party:** Why is Yok upset even though her friends are still with her?
- **When Abby stays close without telling Yok to smile:** How does giving disappointment some time help?
- **When Yok opens the memory book:** Why does the small gift feel big inside her chest?

After reading

1. Name one thing you hoped would happen.
2. Name one feeling you might have if the plan changed.
3. Think of one thing that could still be fun.
4. Remember: disappointed and grateful can both be true.

Parent Conversation Card



Ask gently

1. Why did Yok keep waiting for a bigger surprise?
2. What helped when the rain changed the party?
3. Why was it useful that nobody told Yok to cheer up right away?
4. What made the memory book feel special?

Grown-up note: Disappointment is not ingratitude. Name the feeling first, then help the child notice what is still enjoyable or meaningful without demanding instant cheerfulness.

Tiny everyday habit: Choose one phrase or strategy from the story and practice it once during a calm moment this week. It is easier to use a skill under stress after it has been rehearsed when things are going well.

Practice Cards



Cut out the cards. Children may say, point, act, or match the phrase.

I FEEL DISAPPOINTED

Name the feeling.

PLANS CHANGED

Notice what happened.

STAY CLOSE

Support without rushing.

WHAT CAN STILL BE FUN?

Look for one good next step.

I NEED A MOMENT

Feelings may need time.

SMALL CAN BE SPECIAL

Meaning is not measured by size.

TRY A NEW PLAN

Flexible thinking.

I CAN FEEL TWO THINGS

Mixed feelings are allowed.

THANK YOU

Notice the care behind the surprise.

Adult tip: Disappointment is not ingratitude. Name the feeling first, then help the child notice what is still enjoyable or meaningful without demanding instant cheerfulness.

Flexible Birthday Thinker Certificate



This certificate is awarded to



for handling a changed plan with
honest feelings and a flexible next step.

- ☐ I named a feeling. ☐ I noticed the plan changed.
- ☐ I found one thing that could still be fun.
- ☐ I remembered that small surprises can matter.

Grown-up

Date

Coloring Page



Color Yok and her friends turning a rainy birthday into a cozy celebration under the shelter.



Plans can change, and a special day can still become special in a different way.

Four Printable Bookmarks



Cut along the lines. Optional: print on cardstock.



**A changed plan
can still hold
something good.**

Yok Everyday

Book 1

[leonnaelauthor.github.io
/yokstories-site/](https://leonnaelauthor.github.io/yokstories-site/)



**Disappointed is
a real feeling.**

Yok Everyday

Book 1

[leonnaelauthor.github.io
/yokstories-site/](https://leonnaelauthor.github.io/yokstories-site/)



**Small surprises
can feel very big.**

Yok Everyday

Book 1

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/yokstories-site/](https://leonnaelauthor.github.io/yokstories-site/)



**Best wet
birthday ever!**

Yok Everyday

Book 1

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/yokstories-site/](https://leonnaelauthor.github.io/yokstories-site/)

Yok's Little Try



Children may draw, point, act, or answer aloud.

1. Hope

Draw or say one thing you hope will happen.

2. Notice

What changed from the plan?

3. Feel

Name the feeling without fixing it yet.

4. Find

What could still be fun or meaningful?

Can you find?

- ☐ the paper crown
- ☐ the upside-down card
- ☐ a bubble

- ☐ the soggy banner
- ☐ the stubborn candle
- ☐ the memory book



Plans can change, and a special day can still become special in a different way.